

Clinical Findings

SUPERFICIAL STAPHYLOCOCCAL PYODERMAS

Pyodermas are infections of the epidermis, just below the stratum corneum, or in hair follicles. In industrialized nations, *S. aureus* is the most common cause of superficial pyodermas. However, group A streptococcus remains a frequent cause of pyoderma in developing countries. If left untreated, these infections can extend into the dermis, leading to complications such as ecthyma and furuncle formation.

Impetigo

Two clinical forms of impetigo are recognized: bullous and non-bullous.

- **Bullous impetigo** is caused exclusively by *S. aureus*.
- **Non-bullous impetigo** is most commonly caused by *S. aureus* in industrialized nations, with group A streptococcus being a less frequent cause. In developing countries, group A streptococcus remains a common etiologic agent of non-bullous impetigo.